

Sikkim

The 'Garden State' of the nation

In recognition of his outstanding contributions towards preservation and protection of ecology, Pawan Chamling, Chief Minister of Sikkim was declared the 'Greenest Chief Minister' of India some time back. Continuing with his efforts to gift the future generations a more secure future, he has given the state a green development agenda, ensuring that Sikkim always ranks first in the field of environmental protection and ecological balance.

SOME MAJOR POLICY INITIATIVES

» State Government passed and announced a Comprehensive State Policy on Forest, Environment and Land Use 2000 based on the basic principle of conservation and sustainability.

» Introduced the Compulsory Environmental Education for schools in 2000. Eco-Club, Green Funds have been created in a number of schools and colleges.

» Environmental Commission set up under the chairmanship of Sunita Narain, Director of Center for Science and Environment, New Delhi.

» Sikkim State Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (SBSAP) formulated under the National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (NBSAP).

» A State Biodiversity Park at Tendong first of its kind was created in 2001.

» Sikkim Green Mission 2006 – To integrate the people with nature and invoke mass support for the cause. All road projects to have green/plantation components. 2% budget of SPWD(R&B) and RMDD and 1 % of all other Departments have been earmarked for the Green Mission.

» For Tourism Development "Tourism Master Plan" has been developed on the committed principle of Eco-tourism and Nature tourism with strict measures.

» As per State Industrial Policy 1996, only eco-friendly, pollution free and Green industries would be encouraged.

» Mandatory Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)/ Environment Management Plan (EMP) and Catchment

Area Treatment (CAT) Plan for all Hydro-Electric Projects (HEP) & Other Projects as well.

» In the MOU/ Agreement signed with Power Projects Proponents, sufficient provisions has been made for Rehabilitation & Resettlement Plan, Environment Cess @ One paise per unit of electricity sold, Catchment Area Treatment (CAT) Plan, EIA/EMP studies with State Government & Maintaining Ecological balance etc.

» Ban on killing of Wildlife and aquatic animals has been imposed by the Government.

» By legislation banned the use of non-biodegradable materials like plastic, polybags, Bio-medical / chemical waste in 1997.

» Organic State – no use of chemicals, pesticides & insecticides etc. and only the use of bio-manure shall be encouraged.

» To preserve the Heritage and fragile ecology, notified in 2001 sacred peaks, caves, rocks, lakes, chorten & hot springs and banned scaling of important peaks including Mt. Khangchendzonga (8598m) for mountaineering expeditions.

» Wetland Conservation Programme for protection, conservation & management lakes and wetlands is being implemented from 2007.

» Glaciers Study & Action Plan: to take timely action on the effect of Global Warming on our water resources, the State Government has constituted a commission to study the state of glaciers and it's impact on water system in Sikkim under the chairmanship of Professor S. I. Hasnain.



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